Online safety and media literacy

Online safety & media literacy (Safer Internet Day).

Aspire · Thursday 21 January 2027 · P4 · Year A

Words to keep

Privacy: control over personal information. Digital footprint: information about a person left online. Manipulated: changed content. Misleading: gives a wrong impression. Source: where an item came from. Context: the wider facts around it.

The invented learner

An invented learner sees a post saying the next activity is cancelled. It shows a cropped notice with no date. A second post shows an edited picture of the empty activity room. The learner pauses before sharing and asks trusted school staff to check the full notice.

Privacy and a footprint

For the invented learner, choose a smaller audience or location off. Explain one way it could help and one limit. A recipient can still copy or share. Deleting a post cannot ensure that all copies vanish. No live account is needed.

Use all three invented media examples on Support Cards page 2. Compare each with its full source and decide what can be checked.

One media example

ACTIVITY CANCELLED TODAY The crop shows only the words Activity cancelled. No date or sender is shown. Full source: Full invented notice dated 14 January 2027: Activity cancelled on 14 January 2027. The next activity on 21 January 2027 will run as usual.

Go deeper

Compare a cropped post with the full source. Explain why a clue is a reason to check rather than proof that everything is false. Decide whether a second post is an independent source or just repeats the first. Keep all normal aids. Frame: This supports ___ but leaves ___ uncertain.

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A safe next step

Story response

The invented learner notices an old activity notice has been shared as if it were current. They pause sharing and ask trusted school staff to check the date and what to do. If a private or upsetting item appears, they stop interacting and tell a trusted adult. They can use report, mute or block tools with adult help as suitable. They do not forward, save or copy harmful or private content for class evidence.

Two task choices

In your book, write or type a short safe response for the learner, OR arrange and explain these actions using pointing or your usual aid: pause sharing, check with trusted staff, use a suitable report or block route with help. Both choices show the same learning. A scribe can record your exact words and read them back.

Private checklist

Use Support Cards page 4 privately if you wish. It stays with you and is not collected. Use the invented learner, leave blank or pass. No passwords, account details or personal incidents.

Learning self check

Tick learning only. All boxes start blank. Pass or use a fictional example. This is not a judgement of someone’s online history or safety.

Learning today	My choice
I can explain one limit of privacy settings.	Ready to explain [ ] With a prompt [ ] Need another example [ ]
I can give a reason to check a misleading post.	Ready to explain [ ] With a prompt [ ] Need another example [ ]
I can suggest a safe next step and a support type.	Ready to explain [ ] With a prompt [ ] Need another example [ ]

Keep your first fictional try. Use one next step and reply in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. Ask school staff privately for help. Use the agreed supervised pause route if needed.

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